

Kun Zhang

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EDUCATION

Universidad de Navarra Master in Economics and Finance (MEF) Relevant: Econometrics, Mathematical Economics, Real Analysis, Statistics & Probability, Advanced Finance, Corporate Finance	Pamplona, Spain <i>Expected 2026</i>
Hanyang University Exchange, College of Economics and Finance	Seoul, Korea <i>Fall 2023</i>
Yantai Institute of Technology B.A.	Shandong, China <i>2024</i>

WORKING PAPER

“Institutional Common Ownership and Executive Mobility”

Supervisor: Prof. José Azar (IESE & UNAV)

Exploiting the BlackRock–BGI merger (2009) as a quasi-natural experiment, I examine how institutional common ownership shapes C-suite executive mobility. Using difference-in-differences and event study designs on a **27.8-million-row panel** linking 13F institutional holdings (58.9M obs.), ExecuComp executive data (31,959 executive-years), and Orbis director moves (24,716 transitions), I find that common ownership *increases* mobility by facilitating within-network labor market channels—rejecting the shadow non-compete hypothesis. Robust across 17 pair-level checks, placebo tests, and high-dimensional fixed effects.

Methods: DiD · Event Study (2005–2020) · FWL high-dim FE · Placebo · RESET · Python (pandas, statsmodels) · Stata · $\text{\LaTeX}$

Presented at: IESE MWOW 2026 (Madrid) · IESE AI Conference (2026)

SELECTED CONFERENCES

IESE MWOW 2026 Madrid Work & Organizations Workshop. Keynotes: Erin L. Kelly (MIT Sloan), Lauren A. Rivera (Kellogg). <i>Paper presented.</i>	Madrid, May 21–22, 2026
IESE AI Conference Delegate	2026
Roads to Development Delegate	2026

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Technical: Python (pandas, statsmodels, NumPy) · Stata · SQL · $\text{\LaTeX}$ · Git · JavaScript

Languages: English (C1) · Chinese (Native) · Spanish (A2)

Seeking: Pre-doctoral Research Assistant positions (2026–2027), with the long-term goal of a Ph.D. in Financial Economics.